

01 FIGHTING LIKE A GIRL

Welcome, expectations, and the first jab.

SEASON

1

WEEK

1

FOCUS

GROWTH MINDSET

KEY PHRASE

“Why not me?”

SUMMARY

This practice introduces fighters to Fight Like A Girl, sets program expectations, and builds team cohesion through introductions. The group discusses what Fighting Like A Girl means, then partners use fist bumps and questions to get to know each other. Training covers stance, reinforces it with the Stance Check music game, introduces the jab, and ends with Boxing Tag.

OBJECTIVES

By the end of this practice, fighters will:

1. Discuss the purpose of the program name Fight Like A Girl
2. Understand program expectations
3. Create a team environment through introductions

MATERIALS

- Mitts & gloves
- Jump ropes
- Speaker
- Fighter journals · one per fighter
- Writing utensils



COACH MESSAGE

20 MIN

SAY

Welcome to Fight Like A Girl. I'm Coach [Name], and I'll be with you for the next 10 weeks this fall. We'll practice every [day of the week] from [time] to [time].

Over the next 10 weeks, you'll learn the basics of boxing, how to move, punch, defend yourself, and build strength and confidence. At the end of the program we'll have a Boxing Show Off, where you'll show your skills in front of your teammates.

Now, let's take a second to think about something together. Our program is called Fight Like A Girl. Why do you think it's called that?

Take two or three answers from the group before you give the program's answer.

SAY

Here's what Fight Like A Girl means to us. It means that girls belong here, in the gym, in the ring, and in any space where hard work and strength matter. It means showing up for yourself and each other. It means giving 100% effort, every practice, even when it's tough.

You will be challenged. You will sweat. You will grow. If you commit to the drills and exercises we've prepared, you'll leave this program stronger, more confident, and proud of what you've accomplished. By the end of these 10 weeks you'll be part of a team that others look up to, a group that represents strength and persistence.

In boxing, and in life, you need to know who's in your corner. That means learning to trust your teammates, and you can't trust someone you don't know.

So today we're going to practice how to introduce ourselves and start a real conversation. Getting to know your teammates builds confidence and respect, in practice and outside of it.

JRNL FIGHTER'S MINDSET JOURNAL**5 MIN**

Say: Everyone turn to page 5 in your journal.

- Everything is printed in the Fighter's Mindset journal, nothing to hand out, nothing to collect.
- Every fighter completes it during expectations, before the first drill.
- The survey is two pages, 5 and 6, the front and back of one tear-out sheet. Fighters complete both sides today.

Fall 2026 pre-post model.

ACTIVITY • INTRODUCTIONS**3-4 ROUNDS**

1. Fighters walk around the room until the coach calls **fist bump**.
 2. Fighters raise a hand until they find a partner, then lower it.
 3. Partners give each other a fist bump.
 4. Partners take turns asking a few questions to get to know each other.
 5. Coach asks one or two fighters to share something they learned, then calls **go** and fighters walk again.
- Repeat three to four times.

SAY

Here's the challenge: if you already know the person you're paired with, your job is to learn something new about them, something you didn't know before.

First, let's do a quick demo. Can I get a volunteer to model with me? ... Let's try it. Go!

Model it with her: fist bump, then two or three questions.

INTENTIONS

10 MIN

Fighters sit or stand in a circle.

SAY

Today's guiding question: how do you intend to Fight Like A Girl today?

Today I will...

My intention for practice is...

- Every fighter shares, no exceptions.
- Fighters write their intention in their journals, they have them from Week 1.
- End each intention with **snap clap**; the group snaps and claps.

TRAINING

20 MIN

STANCE New skill

- Fighters line up shoulder to shoulder in a straight line, facing the coach or the board.
- Watch the stance video, or explain stance yourself.
- If right handed, step back with the right foot. If left handed, step back with the left foot.
- Feet diagonal, as if on train tracks. Knees bent. Hands up by the face. Chin down. Elbows in.
- Fighters get into their stance.
- Give each fighter a nudge to check her balance; fighters adjust as needed.

WATCH OUT

- Knees bent.
- Hands stay up.

STANCE CHECK

Music game · reinforce stance

The point of this game is proper stance, not speed. Every call is a stance check, walk the room and look at feet, hands, and chin.

1. Play music. Fighters move around the room however they want, walk, dance, jog.
2. Cut the music and call **stance**. Every fighter drops into her boxing stance and holds it.
3. Check each fighter: correct foot forward, feet diagonal on the train tracks, knees bent, hands up, chin down.
4. Anyone who keeps moving after the call, or whose stance is wrong, is out for that round.
5. Fighters who are out become extra eyes, they help check stances for the rest of the round.
6. Three rounds. Everyone comes back in each round; hold the calls longer each time.

WATCH OUT

- Name what you see out loud so the whole group hears the correction.
- Being out is quick, never a punishment. Keep the pace fast and the tone light.

JAB (1)

New skill

- Watch the jab video, or explain the jab yourself.
- The lead hand travels straight out from the face and returns straight back to the face.
- Turn the wrist over as the punch is thrown, palm facing down at the end.
- It should feel like snatching something out of the air.
- On the call **jab**, fighters throw the jab, 10 times.

WATCH OUT

The hand never drops, it stays up by the face at all times.

- Give fighters two minutes to throw jabs at their own pace, holding stance between punches.
- Give individual feedback on form and effort to every fighter.

BOXING TAG

Game · 3 rounds

1. Fighters find a partner and stand across from them in boxing stance.
2. On **go**, each fighter tries to tap her partner's shoulder while moving forward and back in stance.
3. Hands stay open and flat. Move in and out as quickly as possible to avoid getting tapped back.
4. The goal is as many taps as possible, this should feel fast-paced.
5. Round 1 lasts one minute.
6. Round 2: find a new partner and get back into stance.
7. Final round: fighters count their taps. Simultaneous touches don't count. First fighter to three touches raises her hand and finds other winners to play until one fighter is left standing.

 BURNOUT

7 MIN

ASSESSMENT

This week the burnout is the assessment: jump rope, unbroken, for 90 seconds. Fighters count out loud and report their number at the end. Record every fighter on the assessment log, page 17.

SONG LENGTH**90 sec min****SUGGESTED TEMPO****140-150 BPM****PASS****90 seconds, no stops****SAY**

Every practice ends with a burnout. It is supposed to burn, and it is supposed to be hard. There will be a point where you hear a voice in your head telling you to stop. What are you going to do when it gets hard?

Today the burnout is your first assessment. I'm going to play one song, at least 90 seconds, and your job is to jump rope the whole way through without stopping. Count every jump out loud, and tell me your number when the song ends. This is your week-one number, the one you get to beat later in the season. If you finish, you cheer on the fighters still going.

1. Every fighter takes a rope and finds her own space.
2. Coach plays one song, 90 seconds minimum, ideally 140–150 BPM.
3. Fighters jump the full 90 seconds without stopping, counting every jump out loud as they go.
4. A fighter who stops before the song ends has not passed this round. She keeps her count and cheers the rest on.
5. At the buzzer, each fighter reports the number of jumps she counted. Record it, with the date and song, on the log on page 17.

WATCH OUT

- Sitting down is not a punishment, say it out loud before you start.
- A tangled rope is not a stop; give her the rope back and keep counting.

 SHOUT-OUTS

3 MIN

SAY

At the end of every practice we give shout-outs. You're celebrating a teammate who worked hard or who helped you. Say "I want to give a shout-out to _____", if you don't know her name, ask, then give your reason. End by saying "snap clap," and the group will echo you by snapping and clapping.

- Model the first shout-out yourself.
- One person per shout-out, never the whole group.

COACH NOTES AFTER PRACTICE

THE SHOUT-OUT FORMULA

"I want to give a shout-out to _____ because _____. Snap clap."

One person, one specific reason. If you don't know her name, ask.

JUMP ROPE ASSESSMENT LOG

Fill this in during the burnout. A fighter who stops before 90 seconds has not passed this round. Write down the number she counted either way. Note one form observation for each fighter.

DATE		SONG USED			LENGTH	
FIGHTER PRESENT		NUMBER OF JUMPS		PASSED	DID NOT	FORM NOTES
01				☐	☐	
02				☐	☐	
03				☐	☐	
04				☐	☐	
05				☐	☐	
06				☐	☐	
07				☐	☐	
08				☐	☐	
09				☐	☐	
10				☐	☐	
11				☐	☐	
12				☐	☐	
13				☐	☐	
14				☐	☐	
15				☐	☐	
16				☐	☐	
17				☐	☐	
18				☐	☐	
19				☐	☐	
20				☐	☐	